m5

Churchill and the Secon

lesson 1

The Second World War

1 The Second World War
2 Symbolic battles
3 Important leaders during the Second World War
4 Life in Britain during the war
Expansion
Check your knowledge

What do you know?

> Work in pairs and match the dates (1-5) with the event (a-e) from the Second World War. Check the text for the correct answer.

1 May 1940	**a** The Japanese bombed Pearl Harbour
2 July 1940	**b** The Germans surrendered at Stalingrad
3 December 1941	**c** The Battle of Britain began
4 February 1943	**d** Hiroshima was bombed
5 August 1945	**e** Churchill became Prime Minister of the UK

Scan for audio lesson **1**

Main events from 1939–1945

1939-1940
The phoney war

Years of tension – encompassing the Spanish Civil War, the Anschluss of Germany and Austria, Hitler's occupation of the Sudetenland and the invasion of Czechoslovakia – culminated in the German invasion of Poland on 1st September 1939. Britain and France declared war on Germany two days later. The USA proclaimed neutrality but it continued to send Britain essential supplies and the critical Battle of the Atlantic between German U-Boats and British naval convoys began.

It was quiet in Western Europe in 1939 and early 1940 during this "phoney war", although preparations for war and an imminent enemy landing in Britain continued. In eastern Europe and Scandinavia, the Ribbentrop Pact had been signed between the Soviet Union and Germany on 23rd August 1939 and Russia also invaded Poland in September. Poland was carved up between the two invaders. Russia continued this aggression by going on to invade Finland. The "winter war" between Russia and Finland concluded in March 1940 and the Baltic republics were occupied by the Soviets in June 1940. After this Germany invaded Denmark and Norway. Denmark surrendered immediately, and Norway surrendered in June 1940.

On 10th May 1940, the same day that Winston Churchill became Prime Minister of the UK, Germany invaded France, Belgium, Luxembourg and Holland, and Western Europe endure the Blitzkrieg – or "lightning war". Germany's combination of fast, armoured tanks on land and superiority in the air, made a

German soldiers on horseback in Paris, June, 1940.



d World War



A British World War II propaganda poster.



December 7th, 1941. The Japanese attack on Pearl Harbour.

GLOSSARY

Anchluss – *l'unificazione della Germania e dell'Austria*
phoney war – *quando i paesi stanno in guerra senza combattimenti.*

unified attacking force that was both innovative and effective. Holland and Belgium fell by the end of May 1940; Paris was taken two weeks later. The Allied armies (France, Poland, the United Kingdom, Australia, Canada, New Zealand and South Africa) retreated from the Axis troops (Germany and its allies) and 338,226 British, Canadian, French and Belgian troops including 198,00 British and Canadian Troops 226,000 British and 140,000 French and Belgian troops were rescued from the channel port of Dunkirk by a fleet of ships, which ranged from pleasure boats to Navy destroyers. As well as leaving from Dunkirk, over 200,000 troops, including over 20,000 Poles, got out from other western ports like Cherbourg and St Malo. France signed an armistice with Germany and the puppet French Vichy government, led by a hero of World War One, Marshall Pétain, took control of the "unoccupied" part of southern and eastern France. Germany controlled the rest of the country. After France, Hitler turned his attention to Britain and began preparations for an invasion. For this to be successful, however, he needed air superiority, so he charged the Luftwaffe with destroying British air power and coastal defences.

The Battle of Britain lasted from July to September 1940 and it was the first battle to be fought solely in the air. However, Hitler's plans to dominate the sky failed and the RAF were able to maintain air superiority and postpone German's invasion plans. The "Blitz" of Britain's cities lasted throughout the war and caused thousands of civilian deaths.

1941 The global battlefield

In 1941 the war took on a more global dimension. Following the defeat of Mussolini's armies in Greece and Tobruk, German forces arrived in North Africa in February and also invaded Greece and Yugoslavia in April.

While the bombing of British and German cities continued, the gas chambers at Auschwitz were being tested on Russian prisoners of war in October 1941. These chambers were to become fully operational in 1942 following the Wannsee Conference of 20th January 1942 which decided the Final Solution and its methods of killing Jews. On the 22nd June 1941, in Operation Barbarossa, Hitler invaded Russia. The bitter Russian winter, however, like the one that Napoleon had experienced a century and a half earlier, crippled the Germans. The Soviets counterattacked in December and the Eastern Front stagnated until the spring. On 7th December 1941, the Japanese mounted a surprise attack on the US Navy base of Pearl Harbour in Hawaii. This act of aggression ensured that global conflict commenced, with Germany declaring war on the US a few days later. Eight days after Pearl Harbour, Japan invaded the Philippines, Malaya, Burma, and Hong Kong: the Pacific war was on. The first Americans arrived in



Soviet propaganda poster, 1943.

England in January 1942 and in North Africa Field Marshal Erwin Rommel's Afrika Korps began their counter-offensive, capturing Tobruk for the second time in June. In November 1942, the Germans suffered their first major defeat against the Allies at the Battle of El Alamein in Egypt. In the Pacific, the Japanese continued their expansion into Borneo, Java and Sumatra, and Singapore fell rapidly in February. In February 1943 the Germans surrendered at Stalingrad. This was the first major defeat of Hitler's armies on the Eastern front.

A member of a German tank crew surrendering as British infantry rush his tank in El Alamein, October 27th, 1942.



1943 War at sea

In the Atlantic Ocean the battle continued and in one four-day period in March 1943, 27 merchant vessels were sunk by German U-boats. However, a combination of long-range aircraft and code-breaking managed to inflict enormous losses on the U-boats. Towards the end of November 1943, the German fleet withdrew after the sinking of the Scharnhorst in the Arctic and the Battle of the Atlantic was effectively over. May 1943 was the turning point of the U-Boat war. The Battle of the Atlantic was effectively won, but not completely over, as the U-boats continued to inflict losses up to the last day of the war.

1943 North Africa and the Pacific

In mid-May 1943, German and Italian forces in North Africa surrendered to the Allies, who used Tunisia as a springboard to invade Sicily in July. By the end of the month, Mussolini had fallen and in September the Italians surrendered to the Allies (and then changed sides) prompting Germany to invade northern Italy. Mussolini was rescued by a German task force and established a fascist republic in the north. German troops also began fighting the Allies in the south of Italy. In the Pacific, US forces overcame the Japanese at Guadalcanal and British and Indian troops began their campaigns in Burma. American progress continued in the Aleutian Islands, New Guinea and the Solomon Islands.

1944 The Eastern Front and Italy

The Russians continued to advance on the Eastern Front and Kharkov and Kiev in Ukraine were recaptured from Germany. Allied bombers began to attack German



American troops landing on Utah beach in Normandy, 6th June 1944.

cities in enormous daylight air raids. In 1944, with advances in Burma, New Guinea and Guam, Japan began its last offensive in China, capturing further territory in the south.

The Allied advance in Italy continued with landings at Anzio which were an attempt to cut the German front line. Monte Cassino was part of the German front line and the Germans counter-attacked in February and the fighting saw the destruction of the medieval monastery at Monte Cassino after Allied bombing. Only at the end of May did the Germans retreat from Anzio. Rome was liberated in June, the day before the Allies' "Operation Overlord", the D-Day landings.

1944 Operation Overlord and D-Day

Operation Overlord was the Allied plan to invade and take North West Europe. It began on the 6th June 1944 with Operation Neptune, also known D-Day, when thousands of troops landed on the Normandy beaches. The landings caught most of the Germans by surprise and they when unable to counter-attack with the necessary speed and strength. Cherbourg was liberated by the end of June. Paris followed two months later. Operation Overlord ended on the 17th August 1944, when the Allied troops crossed the River Seine. Hitler's troubles were compounded by a Russian offensive in June. Operation Bagration was significant because it took Soviets into Poland and out of the USSR. By the end of August, the Russians had taken Bucharest. Estonia was taken within months, and Budapest was under siege by the end of the year. The war was not over though and in December 1944, at the Battle of the Bulge in the Ardennes, France, the Germans killed 19,000 Americans and delayed the Allies' march into Germany.

1945 Liberation

The New Year of 1945 saw the Soviet liberation of Auschwitz and the revelation of the Holocaust – its scale becoming clearer as more camps were liberated in the following months. The Soviet army continued its offensive from the east, while from the west the Allies established a bridge across the Rhine at Remagen in March. Although the bombing campaigns of the Blitz were over, German V1 and V2 rockets continued to drop on London. On the 21st April, Berlin came into the artillery range of Soviet guns. Hitler killed himself on the 30th April, two days after Mussolini had been captured and shot and his body taken to Milan and strung up by Italian partisans. Germany surrendered unconditionally on the 7th May, and the following day was celebrated as VE (Victory in Europe) Day. The war in Europe was over. In the Pacific, however, it had continued to rage throughout this time. The British advanced further in Burma and in February the Americans invaded Iwo Jima. The Philippines and Okinawa followed and Japanese forces began to withdraw from China.



German troops freeing Mussolini, September 12th, 1943.

1945 Atomic warfare

Plans were being prepared for an Allied invasion of mainland Japan but fears of fierce resistance and massive casualties prompted Harry Truman, the new American president, to sanction the use of an atomic bomb against Japan. On the 6th August, the aircraft *Enola Gay* bombed Japanese city of Hiroshima. Three days later, another atomic bomb was dropped on Nagasaki. The devastation the bombs caused was unprecedented and the Japanese surrendered on 14th August 1945.

1945 The War is over

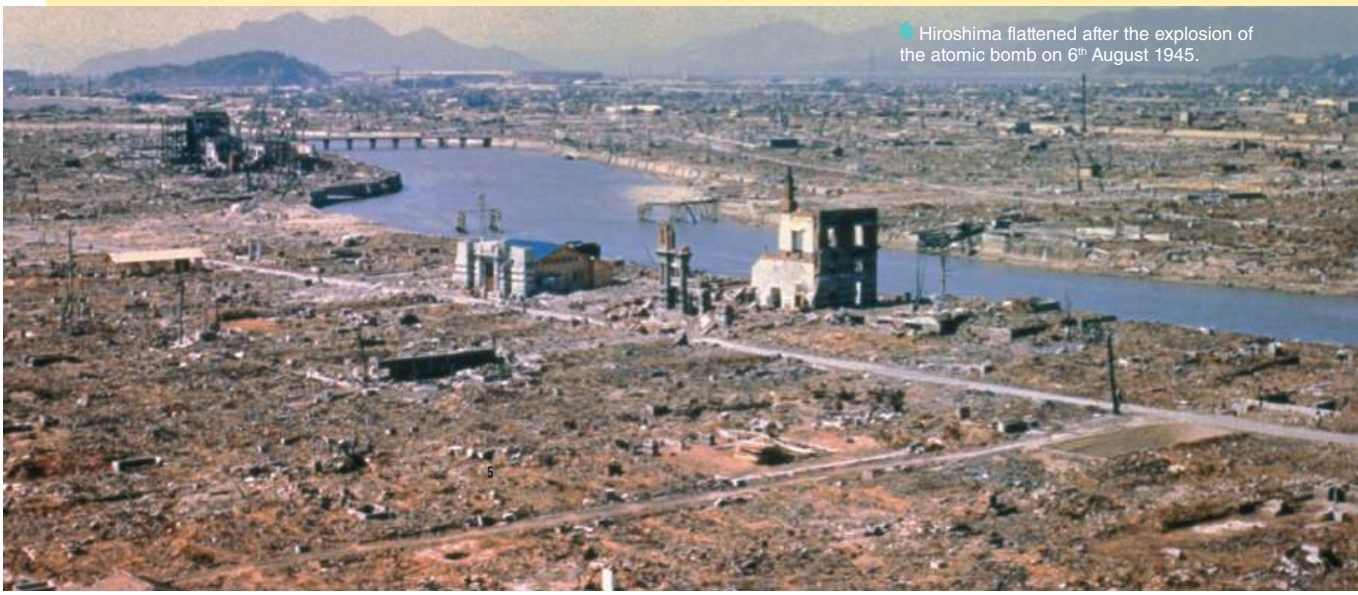
The biggest conflict in history had lasted almost six years. Over 100 million people had fought in World War II, and in a war that involved countries all around the world, between 50 and 78 million people had been killed. From 1939 to 1945, 10 to 20 million civilians lost their lives. Of those who had died, 15 million were soldiers, 20 -25 million were Russian civilians, six million were Jews and over four million were Poles (including Polish Jews). Also between 500,000 and 1.3 million Gypsies (Roma) were killed.



Russian soldiers raise the Soviet Flag on the German Parliament building, April 1945.



Prisoners in Buchenwald, the Nazi Concentration camp, shortly before their liberation by the Allies in April 1945.



Hiroshima flattened after the explosion of the atomic bomb on 6th August 1945.

Key events in World War II

1th September 1939
Germany invades
Poland _____

(2) _____

(3) _____

(4) _____

(5) _____

(6) _____

(7) _____

(8) _____

(9) _____

(10) _____

(11) _____

Often primary and secondary sources may not always introduce events in chronological order. In this case a timeline will help you to understand the events and study them in the order they happened. Identify the main facts or events and the date in which they took place and then list them in the order they took place.

To make a more visual draw a straight line down the centre of your page. Mark the centre of the line and other small marks at equal distances to mark the passage of time. You can mark time in months, days or years or centuries and write the event under each line marked.

TIMELINE

1 **Read the text on pages 38-42 about events in World War II from 1939-1945. Guess the meaning of the underlined words. In pairs, compare your answers and check them in a dictionary.**

2 **In pairs, read the text again and complete the timeline with key events in chronological order. Write the month, the year and the name of the event.**

3 **Group discussion**

In groups answer the question: do you think the world has learnt from the Second World War? Give reasons and examples for your opinion.

4 **Internet link**

Find out more about the bombing of the Japanese cities of Hiroshima and Nagasaki. What were the effects of the atom bomb on these cities and their population?

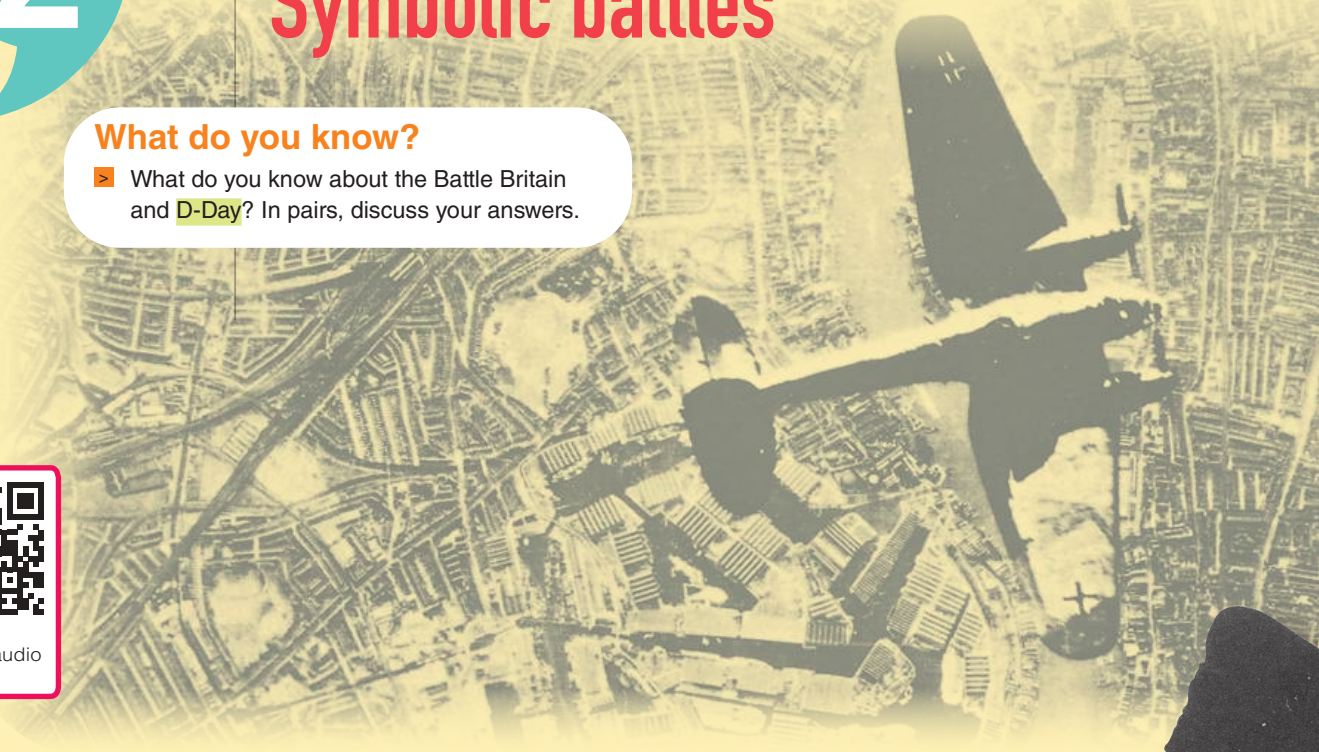


Symbolic battles

What do you know?

> What do you know about the Battle Britain and D-Day? In pairs, discuss your answers.

Scan for audio lesson **2**



A German plane flying over a London suburb during the Blitz.

The Battle of Britain

On the 18th June 1940, Churchill gave a speech to the British people, announcing: "[...] the Battle of France is over. The Battle of Britain is about to begin." On the 22nd June 1940, France surrendered to Germany. Churchill refused Hitler's offer of Peace, so Hitler ordered the invasion of Britain which was called Operation Sealion. Hermann Goering, the head of the Luftwaffe, was instructed to beat down the Royal Air Force so it would be unable to stop a subsequent German sea and land attack on Britain. Although the Luftwaffe appeared to have the advantage in numbers of planes, pilots and experience, the two air forces were, in fact, evenly matched. The short range of the German planes and the fact they were fighting over enemy territory were both serious disadvantages for the Luftwaffe. The RAF also had radar, an invaluable tool for detecting enemy raids. Another important factor was the fact that British pilots who were shot down, often parachuted to safety and were sometimes back in a plane ready to fight again the same day, whereas German pilots shot down over England finished in prison camps. The battle began in mid-July and the Luftwaffe concentrated on attacking shipping in the English Channel, coastal towns and defences.



glossary

D-Day – *in ambito militare, il giorno in cui deve iniziare un attacco o un'operazione di combattimento*

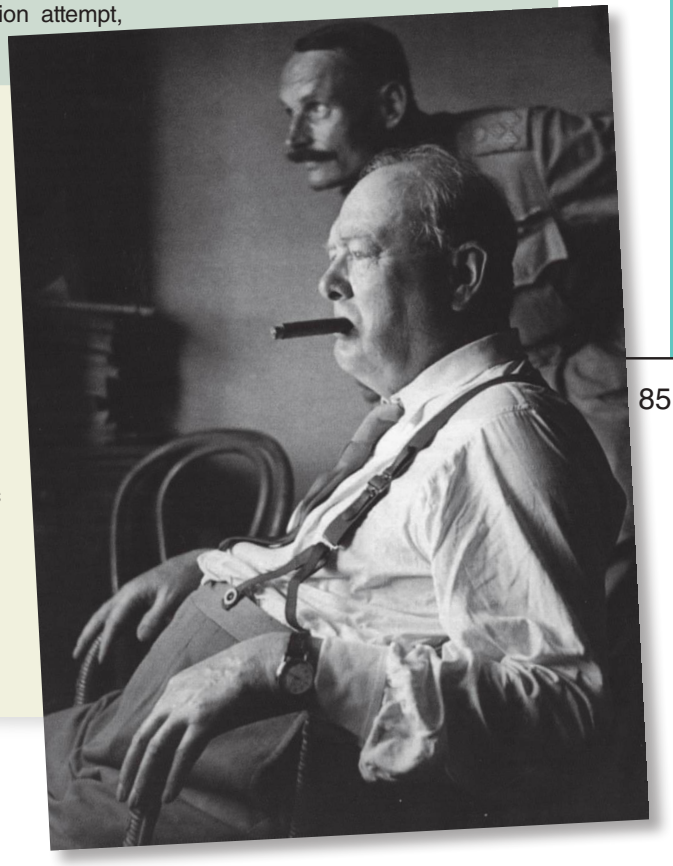
SOURCE B A POLITICAL SPEECH

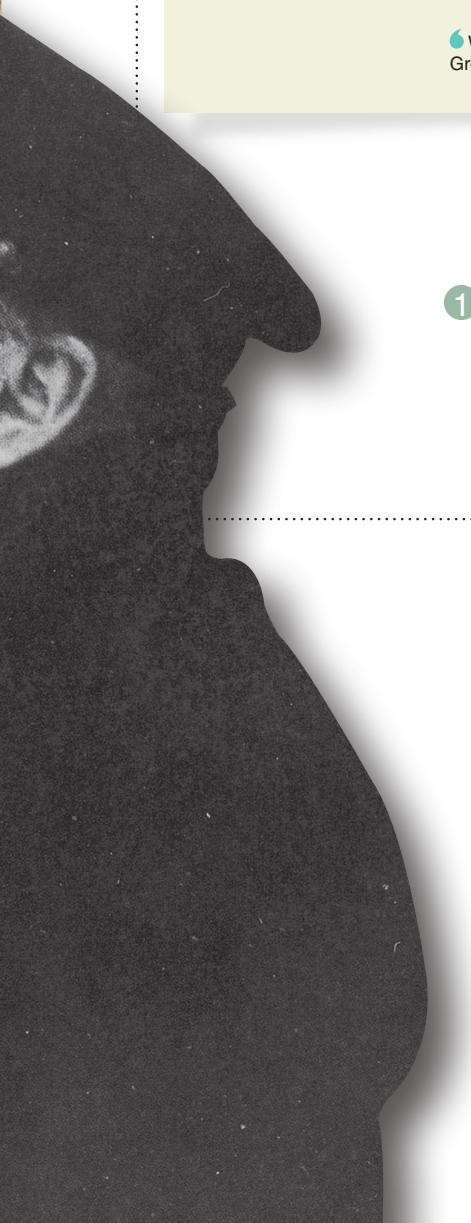
We Shall Fight on the Beaches This is a common title given to a speech delivered by Winston Churchill to the House of Commons of the Parliament of the United Kingdom on the 4th June 1940. In this speech, Churchill had to warn of a possible Nazi German invasion attempt, without casting doubt on eventual victory.

Even though large tracts of Europe and many old and famous States have fallen or may fall into the grip of the Gestapo and all the odious apparatus of Nazi rule, we shall not flag or fail. We shall go on to the end. We shall fight in France, we shall fight on the seas and oceans, we shall fight with growing confidence and growing strength in the air, we shall defend our island, whatever the cost may be.

We shall fight on the beaches, we shall fight on the landing grounds, we shall fight in the fields and in the streets, we shall fight in the hills; we shall never surrender, and if, which I do not for a moment believe, this island or a large part of it were subjugated and starving, then our Empire beyond the seas, armed and guarded by the British Fleet, would carry on the struggle, until, in God's good time, the new world, with all its power and might, steps forth to the rescue and the liberation.

Winston Churchill, Prime Minister of Great Britain from May 1940 to 1945.





1 **In pairs, read the extract from Churchill's speech and answer the questions.**

1 Who do you think Churchill is speaking to?
2 What is Churchill's key message in this source?
3 Why is the phrase "We shall fight on the Beaches" symbolic?

1 Match the battle code names (1-3) to the plan a-c.

1 Operation Sealion	**a** The Normandy Landings
2 Operation Overlord	**b** The Allied invasion of North West Europe
3 Operation Neptune	**c** Hitler's plan to invade Britain

2 Group discussion

Why do you think 6th June 1944 was also known as D-Day in terms of the final outcome of the Second World War?



The Allied troops landing on Omah beach on D-Day in Normandy.

From the 12th August, Goering changed his focus to the destruction of the Royal Air Force, attacking airfields and radar bases. British planes continued to fight off the German attack and this caused a lot of frustration for Goering. On the 7th September, under Hitler's orders, the Luftwaffe changed tactics and began bombing London (other been bombed cities in Britain had been bombed at the end of August). This was known as the "Blitz". Eleven days later, on what became known as "Battle of Britain Day", the RAF destroyed the huge incoming Luftwaffe formations in the skies above London and the south coast. It was now clear to Hitler that his air force had failed to gain air superiority, so on the 17th September, he postponed his plans to invade Britain. He moved his attention to the invasion of the Soviet Union, although the Luftwaffe continued to bomb Britain until the end of the war. It's difficult to establish an exact figure of how many aircraft were shot down in the Battle of Britain, partly because both sides tended to exaggerate their successes and downplay their losses. However, it is estimated that between the 10th July and the end of October 1940, the RAF lost around 1,023 aircraft while the Luftwaffe lost 1,887.

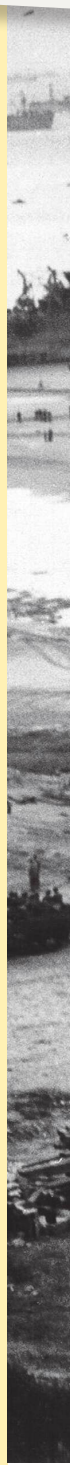
Operation Overlord

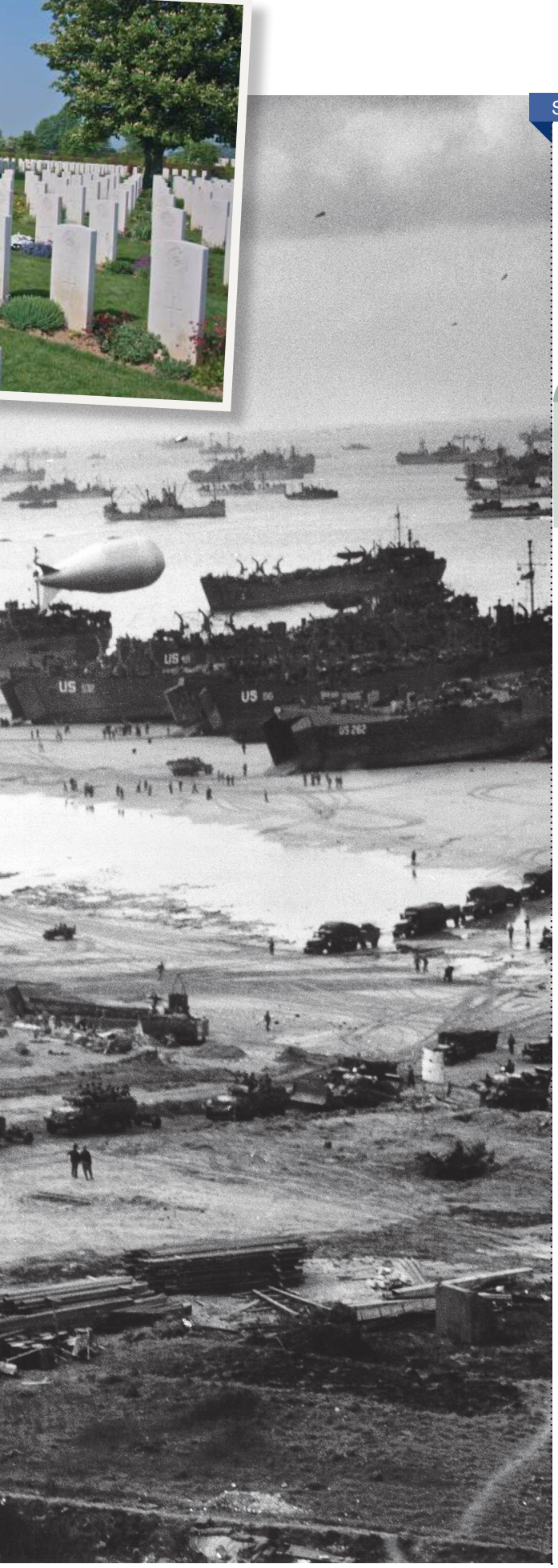
This was the codename for Allied invasion of northwest Europe. The landing operations of the Allied invasion of Normandy were called Operation Neptune which began on what is known as D-Day, 6th June 1944, and ended on 30th June 1944, by which date the Allies had established a firm foothold in Normandy. The operation was the largest amphibious invasion in world history and was executed by land, sea, and air. The Supreme Commander of the Allied forces was General Dwight Eisenhower. About, 9,000 vessels landed over 156,000 Allied forces on five Normandy beaches: codenamed Utah, Omaha, Gold, Juno and Sword. Air superiority was secured for the Allies by 12,000 aircraft bombing German defences and providing cover. On Utah beach 23,000 troops landed, with 197 casualties including 60 missing in action (M.I.A). Most of the 4,649 American casualties and 1928 M.I.A. that day occurred at Omaha beach, where the landing was significantly more difficult to achieve, meeting with fierce German resistance.

During Operation Neptune, which lasted from the 6th June to the 30th June, there were also 2,499 casualties for the airborne troops who did not drop directly on the beaches but further inland. Approximately 230 died and the rest were M.I.A. or wounded, this includes 100 glider pilots. The campaign led to the loss of the German position in most of France and the secure establishment of a new major front in Europe.



British soldiers' tombstones at the War Cemetery in Bayeux, Normandy, France.





STUDYING SOURCES HISTORICAL INSCRIPTIONS

Inscriptions are often found on tombstones, road markers, moments, triumphal arches, buildings and walls. When studying historical inscriptions read the text carefully and note down any new vocabulary.

Consider the language of the inscription and why that language is used. Translate the inscription and make a note of its key message/s.

SOURCE C AN HISTORICAL INSCRIPTION

In the name of William the Conqueror At the Bayeux Memorial in Normandy, a monument erected by Britain has a Latin inscription on the memorial which reads "NOS A GULIELMO VICTI VICTORIS PATRIAM LIBERAVIMUS".

1 **Translate and define the message of this inscription. Why do you think it is in Latin?**

Symbolic locations

The Normandy beaches

The beaches at Normandy are still referred to on maps and signposts by their invasion codenames. The beaches were called the following: Sword, Gold (British), Juno (Canadian) and Omaha, Utah (American). Monuments and military relics continue to remind visitors of the battles. The Bayeux War Cemetery with 4,648 burials, is the largest British cemetery of the war and one of several war cemeteries in the area.



lesson 3

Important leaders during the Second World War

Scan for audio lesson **3**

What do you know?

> What do you know about Operation Overlord or the Manhattan Project? In pairs, discuss your answers.

FACT FILE



Name: **Harry S. Truman**

Born: 8th May 1884, Lamar, Missouri

Died: 26th December 1972, Kansas City

Education: Kansas City Law School

Biography: Harry Truman was the 33rd President of the United States of America who oversaw the end of the Second World War, including the atomic bombing of Japan. His political career started in 1923 when he became active in Democrat politics in Missouri and was elected to the senate in 1934 and re-elected in 1940. In 1941, he headed the Truman Committee investigating waste and fraud in the US defence programme. In April 1945, Roosevelt died and Truman became president. With very little preparation, he faced huge responsibilities in the final months of the war, including authorising the use of the atomic bomb against Japan and planning the post-war world. In foreign policy, he responded to the growing threat from the Soviet Union. He issued the Truman Doctrine, justifying support for any country the US believed to be threatened by Communism. He introduced the Marshall Plan to rebuild Europe. When the Soviets blockaded the western sectors of Berlin in the summer of 1948, Truman authorised an airlift of supplies until the Soviets backed down. Truman won the 1948 presidential election even though his pro-civil rights actions had alienated many southern Democrats. In the summer of 1950, he authorised US military involvement in the Korean War. Truman did not contest the elections of 1952 and he left the Presidency in January 1953.

Name: **Winston Leonard Spencer Churchill**

Born: 30th November 1874, Blenheim Palace, Oxfordshire

Died: 24th January 1965, London

Education: Sandhurst Royal Military College

Biography: Winston Leonard Spencer Churchill was the Prime Minister of Great Britain from 1940-1945 and 1951-1955 His political career began in 1900 when he became the Conservative Member of Parliament for Oldham, near Manchester. He became disaffected with his party and in 1904 joined the Liberal Party. When the Liberals won the 1906 election, Churchill was appointed undersecretary at the Colonial Office and became Home Secretary



in 1910. The following year he became first Lord of the Admiralty. He held this post in the first months of World War One but after the disastrous Dardanelles expedition, for which he was blamed, he resigned. He joined the army, serving for a time on the Western Front. In 1917, he was back in government as Minister of Munitions. From 1919 to 1921, he was Secretary of State for War and from 1924-1929, Chancellor of the Exchequer.
The next decade were his "wilderness years", in which his opposition to Indian self-rule and his support for Edward VIII during the "Abdication Crisis" made him unpopular, while his warnings about the rise of Nazi Germany and the need for British rearmament were ignored. When war broke out in 1939, Churchill became First Lord of the Admiralty. In May 1940, Churchill became Prime Minister. His refusal to surrender to Nazi Germany inspired the country. He worked tirelessly throughout the war, building strong relations with US President Roosevelt while maintaining a sometimes difficult alliance with the Soviet Union. Churchill lost power in the 1945 post-war election but remained Leader of the Opposition, voicing apprehensions about the Cold War (he coined the term "Iron Curtain") and encouraging European and trans-Atlantic unity.
In 1951, he became Prime Minister again. He resigned in 1955 but remained an MP until shortly before his death. As well as his many political achievements, he wrote many books and in 1953 won the Nobel Prize for Literature.



Name: **Dwight David Eisenhower**

Born: 14th October 1890, Denison, Texas

Died: 25th March 1969, Washington DC

Education: West Point US Military Academy

Biography: Dwight David Eisenhower was the Supreme Allied Commander in Europe during the Second World War and went on to become the 34th President of the United States. Shortly after the United States entered the war in May 1942, Eisenhower was appointed commanding general in the European theatre. This was later extended to include the Mediterranean and North Africa. In December 1943 he was named the Supreme Commander of the Allied expeditionary forces in Western Europe. He oversaw the successful Allied assault on the coast of Normandy in June 1944 and the Allied liberation of Western Europe. On the 7th May 1945, he accepted Germany's surrender and then commanded the US occupation zone in Germany. In November 1945, Eisenhower returned to the US as the Army Chief of Staff. He was made the President of Columbia University in 1948 but left in December 1950 to become the Supreme Commander of NATO forces in Europe. In 1952, the popularity which Eisenhower had gained during the war helped him win the Republican nomination for presidency and then the presidency itself. His time in office was dominated by the Cold War. In July 1953, he agreed to an armistice to end the fighting in Korea. At home, Eisenhower expanded social security provisions and introduced the interstate highway system. Eisenhower was re-elected in November 1956. He retired at the end of his second term in January 1961.

1 Read about important leaders during the Second World War and answer the questions in pairs. Match each statement 1-6 to the leader.

HT (Harry Truman) **WC** (Winston Churchill) **DE** (Dwight Eisenhower)

1 He was Supreme Commander of the Allied forces in Western Europe during the Second World War. HT WC DE
2 He was Prime Minister of Great Britain during the Second World War. HT WC DE
3 He ordered the atomic bombing of Japan. HT WC DE
4 He introduced the Marshall Plan to rebuild Europe after the Second World War. HT WC DE
5 After the Second World war he became the 34th President of the United States. HT WC DE
6 He coined the term Iron Curtain. HT WC DE

2 Internet link

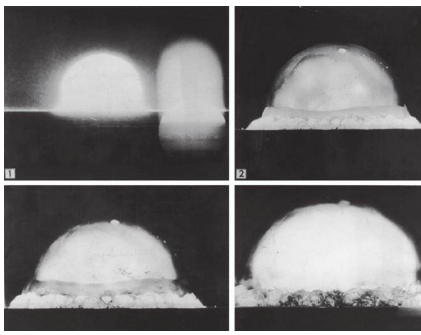
Search the internet and find out more about the abdication of Edward VIII. When did this happen? Why did he abdicate? Do you think he was right to abdicate?

CLIL CONNECTIONS

SCIENCE

The Manhattan Project

This was the research and development programme, led by the United States with the participation of the United Kingdom and Canada, that produced the first atomic bomb during the Second World War. It was given the code name The Manhattan Project. Two types of atomic bomb were developed during the war. One, nicknamed Little Boy, was a simple gun-type fission weapon which proved impractical to use with plutonium, so a more complex implosion-type weapon was developed, nicknamed Fat Man. Little Boy and Fat Man were used in the atomic bombings of Hiroshima and Nagasaki respectively in 1945.



1 Group discussion

Why do you think the Americans decided to use the Atom bomb? Do you think it was the right decision?

2 Internet Link

Search the internet to find out more about atomic weapons. Which countries in the world have nuclear weapons today? What is being done to stop some countries building nuclear weapons? Share your results with a partner.

lesson 4

Life in Britain during the war

What do you know?

> What was the Blitz? Why do you think Britain was known as the "Home Front"?



The scene of destruction the morning after a night of bombing by the Germans in London, 1940.

Scan for audio lesson **4**

The Home Front

Great Britain was called the "Home Front" during the Second World War because people in Britain felt that they were part of the war. The war affected everyone whether they were on the front line (in Europe) or on the home front (back in Britain). Not everyone went to fight but everyone helped in the war effort in some way or other. The first German air raid on London took place on the 7th September 1940. Other cities in Britain including Liverpool, Birmingham, Coventry were bombed too. This became known as the Blitz. To protect themselves, people built shelters (called Anderson shelters) made of corrugated iron in their gardens. At the height of the bombings, about 150,000 people in London took shelter in the stations of the London Underground. Civilians were issued with gas masks to wear as protection during air raids. During air raids everyone had to cover up their windows at night with black material and street lamps were turned off. This was called the Black Out and the darkness made it difficult for German bombers to find their target at night. To escape the bombings of cities, about 1.9 million children together with 1.8 million adults (including teachers and mothers) from British cities were evacuated during the war to the countryside where there was





GLOSSARY

shelter – *rifugio*

corrugated iron – *lamiera ondulata*

Neighbours wearing their gas masks.

Londoners sleeping on the escalators in the London Underground during the Blitz.

less risk of air raids. Between 14-15,000 children also went to other countries such as Canada, Australia and the United States. After the Blitz, many returned. German U-boat submarine attacks on British Merchant ships led to food shortages. In January 1940, rationing of foods in short supply began. People registered with their usual shops and were given ration books containing coupons which they could exchange for set amounts of food. Paper and other things like soap (one bar a month) and washing powder were also rationed. During the war, entertainment was controlled by the government and cinemas showed films about how well the war effort was going in order to keep up the morale of the population. One of the most famous singers at this time was Vera Lynn. Her songs *We'll meet again* and *There'll be Bluebirds over the White Cliffs of Dover* have become iconic symbols of wartime Britain. Vera Lynn became known as the "Forces Sweetheart" because she travelled around Europe entertaining the troops. Where possible, the government wanted the British public to think that life went on as normal, despite the war. Such a control on information was unprecedented in British history.

Many civilians who were not willing or able to join the military became members of local defence organizations. The Home Guard (also known as Dad's Army), was set up in 1938 to protect the Home Front against a possible German invasion. The Air Raid Precautions Service (ARP), was responsible for the safety of the population during air raids and also for issuing gas masks. During the Blitz, The Scout Association guided fire engines to where they were most needed. By 1941, women between the age of 19-30 had to register for war work. The WVS (Women's Voluntary Services for Civil Defence) was set up to organize the evacuation of children. By the end of 1941, it had one million members.

1 **Read the text and in pairs match the underlined words and phrases (1-5) with the definitions (a-e).**

1 Home Front
2 Front line
3 Air raid
4 Rationing
5 Black Out

a period when all lights must be put out or covered
b attack by aircraft dropping bombs
c the civilians in a country at war
d an official allowance of something in a time of shortage
e the line of fighting which is closest to the enemy

2 **Why had the threat of an invasion of Britain passed by May 1941? Discuss in pairs.**



May 1945, a Victory in Europe Day Street party in Brockley, South East London.

KEY CONCEPT

The Blitz – This term comes from the German word "lightning". The Blitz was the continued strategic bombing of Britain by Nazi Germany between the 7th September 1940 and the 10th May 1941, during the Second World War. Many towns in Great Britain were bombed. The city of London was bombed by the Luftwaffe for 76 consecutive nights. During the Blitz, in London alone, more than one million houses were destroyed or damaged. More than 40,000 civilians were killed, half of them in London. The bombing did not achieve its intended goal of demoralising the British into surrender or significantly damaging their war economy. By May 1941, the threat of an invasion of Britain had passed.

Fact File

Name: **Cyril Kenneth Bird** (Fougasse)

Born: 17th December 1887, London, UK

Died: 11th June 1965, London, UK

Education: Kings College London

Biography: Cyril Kenneth Bird was a cartoonist, illustrator and commercial designer best known for his cartoons drawn in a simple linear style. Bird illustrated many cartoons for the satirical magazine Punch under the name Fougasse (land mine). During the Second World War, he produced a number of public information posters for London transport and the British Government. His witty observational humour was a bold new way of communicating with passengers which was important during the war. The British Government was concerned that Nazi spies could be operating in Britain and in response they asked Fougasse to design posters for them. He created the "Careless Talk Costs Lives" series. Fougasse suggested that humour was a perfect vehicle for propaganda posters which had the objective of ensuring that people looked at, reflected on and then remembered the message. He was awarded a CBE in 1946 for his work during the Second World War.



Throughout the war, the King of England George VI and Queen Elizabeth provided morale-boosting visits throughout the United Kingdom, visiting bomb sites and factories, and, in the King's case, visiting military forces abroad.

The British government found that propaganda posters were a very effective tool to inform and influence the people of Britain during the war. Many posters were by the artist Cyril Kenneth Bird under the pseudonym Fougasse. The posters were divided into six key themes, which reflected the principal concerns and preoccupations of the British Government during the Second World War. The themes were: specialist recruiting, industrial production, maintaining morale, security concern, savings and austerity, and health and safety.

Although the bombing raids on Britain declined after 1941, new dangers emerged in 1944 and 1945. These were the V1 and V2 attacks. The V1 planes (nicknamed doodlebugs) had no pilots and the V2s were unmanned rockets causing a lot of damage especially in the south of London. They made a lot of noise as they approached their target and then went silent before they exploded.

On 8th May 1945 Winston Churchill announced Victory in Europe Day. This marked the end of the Second World War in Europe. Street parties were held all over Britain to celebrate the end of the war.

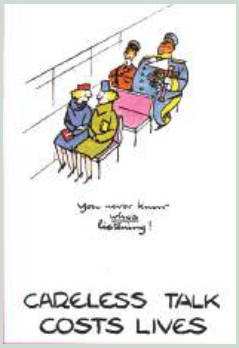
Posters may not present a complete view of reality and often combine visual elements and words which may exaggerate or under state the size of the objects distorting their shape and stereotyping the characters

- **Identify the designer of the poster including the date it was made.**
- **Look quickly at the poster and focus your attention on its main features.**
- **Identify symbols, characters and actions that take place in the poster.**
- **Identify the event that is being depicted.**
- **Explain the context of the poster.**
- **Interpret key messages**
- **Identify the message of the poster.**
- **Who is the intended audience and what is the aim of the poster.**
- **Read the captions or words used in the cartoons.**
- **Identify the purpose of the poster and the importance of its message being delivered to the readers at the moment of time. Why was the poster or cartoon created?**
- **Identify whether the facts depicted in the poster are accurate or inaccurate.**
- **Say if the poster is useful or not in learning about the events it depicts.**

SOURCE D PROPAGANDA POSTERS

British World War II posters

1



2



3



4



5



6



1 Study the propaganda posters from Britain in World War II. In pairs, answer the questions. Use the internet to help you.

1 What message does each poster give?
2 What aspects of life on the Home Front in Second World War do the posters illustrate?
3 Do you agree or disagree with these messages? Write a paragraph explaining your answer.

2 Sort the posters into the following categories; maintaining morale, security concern, savings and austerity, health and safety.

3 Group discussion

Which poster do you think is most effective and why? Which are relevant today?

4 Internet link

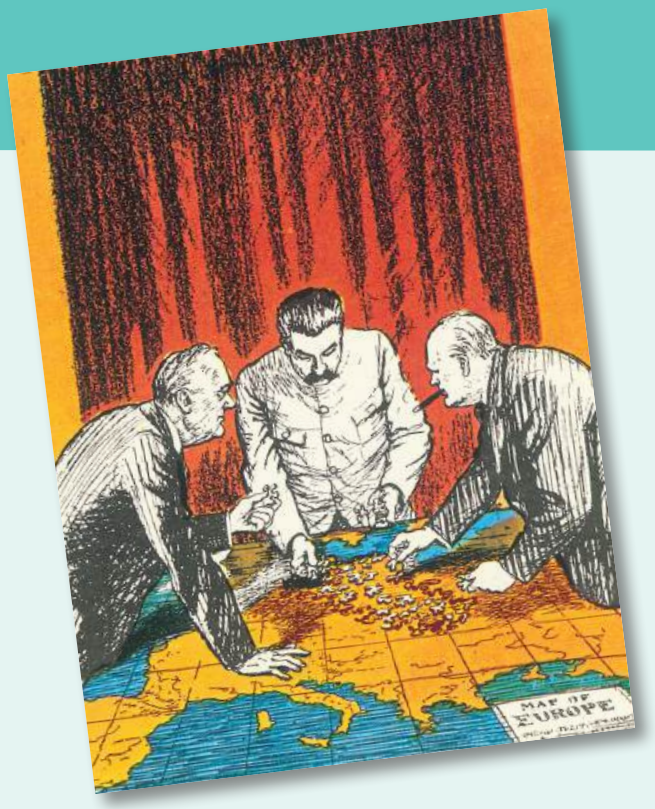
Work in groups and surf the Internet to find out about propaganda posters that were produced in Italy and other countries during World War II. What were their messages? What aspects of the war did they reflect? Prepare a short presentation about them.

project work

CODENAMES FOR MILITARY OPERATIONS IN WORLD WAR II

The armed forces used codenames to refer to the planning and execution of specific military operations. Find out about other codenames for battles used during the Second World War and in other wars. Make notes as your research.

> **Prepare a powerpoint presentation about these codenames and the military operations they represented. Use videos, photographs and documents to illustrate your presentation.**



CLIL CONNECTIONS

LITERATURE

The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe
by C.S. Lewis

This book, one of the series of the Chronicles of Narnia was written by C.S. Lewis and published in 1950. When the Pevensie family are evacuated out to the countryside to escape the Blitz in World War II, they are unaware of the adventure they will encounter. During a game of hide and seek, the youngest daughter Lucy discovers a wardrobe which transports her to the land of Narnia. Covered in snow, Narnia is full of weird and wonderful creatures but is watched over by the evil White Witch. When all four Pevensie children end up through the wardrobe, they discover that they must join with the mighty lion, Aslan to defeat the evil White Witch.



CLIL CONNECTIONS

CINEMA



Saving Private Ryan (1998)
Director: Steven Spielberg.
Actors: Tom Hanks, Matt Damon, Tom Sizemore.

Following the Normandy Landings, a group of US soldiers go behind enemy lines to retrieve a paratrooper whose brothers have been killed in action. The film opens with the Allied invasion of Normandy on 6th June 1944. Members of the 2nd Ranger Battalion under Captain Miller fight ashore to secure a beachhead. Amidst the fighting, two brothers are killed in action. Earlier in New Guinea, a third brother is killed in action. Their mother, Mrs Ryan, is to receive all three of the grave telegrams on the same day. The United States Army Chief of Staff, George C. Marshall is given an opportunity to alleviate some of her grief when he learns of a fourth brother, Private James Ryan and he decides to send out eight men (Captain Miller and select members from 2nd Rangers) to find him and bring him home to his mother. The men have mixed feelings about risking their lives to "Save Private Ryan".

CHECK YOUR KNOWLEDGE

1 Answer the questions from Module 3.

1 What was Operation Sealion?
2 Explain what blackouts were?
3 What names did the Allies give to the beaches in Normandy?
4 Where did people in Britain hide during air raids?
5 Who was evacuated from London?
6 What was rationing and why was it introduced?
7 Where was the "Home Front"?
8 Who was Winston Churchill?
9 How did the British Government try to keep up the morale of the people during World War II?
10 Why do you think the Normandy landings were so important in securing the Allied victory in World War II?

2 What were the professions of the following people during the Second World War?

a Dwight David Eisenhower
b Harry S. Truman
c Winston Leonard Spencer Churchill
d Cyril Kenneth Bird

3 Read the text and choose the correct alternative (1-8).

On the 1st June (1) **1939 / 1944** the first "flying bombs" or V1/V2 hit (2) **Berlin / London**. These jet planes flew very (3) **fast / slowly** and carried a big load of explosives. They had (4) **no / two *pilots***. They made a lot of noise and then became (5) **silent / very loud** before they exploded. A constant stream of them flew in. Their nickname was (6) **doodlebugs / sealions**. Guns on the ground and jet planes (7) **shot / flew** down some of the V1s. They caused a lot of damage in the (8) **south of London / Belfast**.

4 Complete the chart referring to World War II with the correct year.

Year	› *Event*
	› Denmark surrenders to Germany
	› The Battle of Britain begins
	› Japanese attacked Pearl Harbour
	› Japan invades Hong Kong
	› Battle of El Alamein
	› Allied landings at Anzio
	› Allied landings on the Normandy Beaches
	› Liberation of Auschwitz
	› The bombing of Hiroshima and Nagasaki